Fire Safety (v1.0.0)

Date Reviewed: 29/01/2025 | **Next Review Date:** 29/01/2026

Person responsible for updating this policy: Hitendrakumar Sharma

Policy Statement

The principal fire safety legislation applicable to England comprises:

- The Regulatory Reform (Fire Safety) Order 2005
- The Fire Safety Regulations 2023
- The Fire Safety Act 2021

Bluestar Care & Support- Bluestar Resourcing believes that staff and every service user should be as safe as possible from the threat of fire or injury in the case of an outbreak of fire. Bluestar Care & Support- Bluestar Resourcing believes that the best way to ensure this state of safety exists is to have robust fire policies and procedures in place, to ensure that staff are well trained to cope with an outbreak of fire or an alarm in a home of a service user and to ensure that appointed fire wardens are in place in accordance with the law in Bluestar Care & Support- Bluestar Resourcing offices.

This policy is intended to set out the values, principles and policies underpinning our Bluestar Care & Support- Bluestar Resourcing approach to fire safety. Bluestar Care & Support- Bluestar Resourcing aims to ensure that, as far as is possible, fires are prevented and in the event of a fire, staff know exactly what to do and how to react.

The goals of Bluestar Care & Support- Bluestar Resourcing are:

- To minimise the risk of workplace fire by the use of adequate fire prevention and risk- assessment techniques
- To ensure that all staff understand what to do in the event of a fire
- To ensure that all staff attend fire training at least annually
- To ensure that, in the event of a fire, Bluestar Care & Support- Bluestar Resourcing premises and homes of a service usercan be evacuated as quickly, safely and efficiently as possible.

Service Users' Home

Staff should be aware of the following:

- Escape routes
- Fire risks (smoking habits of the service user, use of electric bar fires, etc.)
- Evacuation risks (e.g. Is the service user immobile or disabled? Is the evacuation route restricted?)

Where evacuation or fire risks are assessed as high then professional fire advice should be sought. Every service user should be encouraged to adopt fire awareness behaviours and to install smoke alarms. Special evacuation arrangements can be made for the service user with limited mobility, wheelchairs or sensory impairments.

Any service user who smokes is encouraged not to smoke in bed and they are informed of the specific dangers and risk to life to themselves and any others living in the property.

Staff are aware of the dangers of using flammable emollient creams when the service user is known to smoke in bed. Dropping cigarettes or matches onto clothing or bedding is dangerous but when flammable creams are involved, this increases the chance of a fire starting and becoming much more intense. The people most vulnerable to fires are older people and those with mobility problems and it's exactly this type of service user who tend to rely on emollient

creams.

Health professionals where possible may consider switching to prescribing non-flammable brands.

Note: In situations when the service user uses emollient creams has an airflow mattress, in effect, the bedding with the cream soaked in, acts as a wick and when the mattress comes into contact with a flame, the mattress essentially can act as a blow torch, intensifying the fire.

On the discovery of or suspicion of a fire, staff should:

- Remain as calm as possible and raise the alarm immediately
- Evacuate the house immediately, helping the service user, visitors or relatives in the home to evacuate as per the evacuation plan.
- Ensure that everybody who was in the house is accounted for
- Close all doors upon leaving
- Call the fire brigade, if not already done
- Ensure that any person not accounted for is immediately reported to a fire brigade officer on arrival
- Contact the Bluestar Care & Support- Bluestar Resourcing head office and report the fire
- Record the details of the incident in the Incident Book in the central office and fill out accident forms in the event of injuries.

Note: If the suspicion of fire is raised by seeing smoke coming from under a door, or by seeing smoke in a closed room, staff should on no account attempt to open the door but should raise the alarm and summon the fire brigade as quickly as possible.

Staff should:

- Never stop to collect valuables or possessions
- Never use lifts (except for disabled stairlifts where there are no alternative means of transporting a service user downstairs)
- Never open doors where they can see smoke coming through unless that is the only means of escape
- Never attempt to re-enter the building until told it is safe to do so by a fire brigade officer.

Housing of Multiple Occupation (HMO)

Generally, dependent on the size of the property supported living premises often have to be registered as an HMO. This is a different process regulated by an enforcement officer employed by West Sussex County Council. Their enforcement control includes fire; therefore, it is very important that where supported living accommodation is registered as an HMO, the full fire requirements from West Sussex County Council must be adhered to and staff aware of their role and responsibilities. When staff are required to work in such registered premises, please ensure that the landlord's fire controls are fully adhered to and shared with staff.

If the property is registered as an HMO then there must be a designated Safety Officer as stated in the revision to the The Fire Safety Regulations 2023, within the business, specifically for the operation of multi-occupied residential buildings, who will be responsible for ensuring compliance and adherence to the revised regulations. Without the appointment of a designated safety officer, the organisation may be liable and incur fines.

Stay Put Schemes

The National Fire Chiefs Council statement on the Stay Put Position.

'Fire and rescue services work with the Local Authority (LA), developers, management committees and tenants to help ensure that the fire safety arrangements in high-rise accommodation are safe and appropriate.

The advice provided by fire and rescue services is based on effective fire safety arrangements that are required, proposed and then provided in the building - these include compartmentation of the building and suitably protected means of escape amongst others.

If there is a fire inside a flat or maisonette the advice is to alert all the people in the flat and leave the property and close all doors. They should follow a pre-determined escape plan and if there is a lot of smoke within the flat, people should crawl along the floor where the air should be clearer and the temperature cooler. They should always use the stairs rather than the lift and call 999 as soon as they are in a safe place.

If there is a fire elsewhere in the building then the structure of the flat, walls, floors and doors are designed to give appropriate protection. Responsible owners need to ensure that high-rise buildings are properly constructed and any refurbishment or maintenance is carried out to compliant standards of fire safety.

If there is a fire in the building, then the service user is usually safer to stay in their own flat unless the heat or smoke

from the fire is spreading. 'Stay Put' schemes are subject to specialist advice from the fire service and are always identified within the foyer of the building as a Stay Put Area. Always call 999 for advice and to ensure that the fire and rescue service along with attending emergency crews have been notified. Staff are made fully aware of any stay-put premises which they visit and are advised accordingly.

The advice provided to tenants can and does change depending on the circumstances that present themselves at what are very dynamic incidents. The advice in this statement is part of a preventative approach to ensure a consistent approach is taken by fire and rescue services to assist tenants in developing an initial and safe escape plan.

Once a 999 call is made, and firefighters arrive at the fire, then the advice may be reinforced or changed, depending on the nature and development of the fire, the building and its tenants.

In the event of a fire you need to understand the procedures you must follow, if the building you are working in stay put.

In the Organisation's Premises

On the discovery of or suspicion of a fire:

- Staff should remain as calm as possible
- The first person aware of the fire or on the scene should raise the alarm immediately by operating the nearest break-glass fire alarm or by shouting 'Fire'
- If the suspicion is raised by seeing smoke coming from under a door, or by seeing smoke in a closed room, staff should on no account attempt to open the door but should raise the alarm and summon the fire brigade as quickly as possible
- Small fires can be fought with the appropriate fire extinguisher, but only if safe to do so, if the individual has received training and if the alarm has already been raised.

In the event of a fire, or of the fire alarm sounding, staff should:

- Evacuate the building immediately and go to the nearest designated fire assembly point
- Remain as calm as possible and help the service user, visitors, disabled persons, or contractors to evacuate from the premises
- Where possible and safe to do so, check all rooms (in particular toilets) to ensure nobody remains in them or are trapped
- Close all doors
- Ensure that any person not accounted for is immediately reported to Service Manager Hitendrakumar Sharma (or deputy), nominated fire warden or directly to a fire brigade officer.

Staff should:

- Never stop to collect valuables or possessions
- Never use lifts
- Never open doors where they can see smoke coming through unless that is the only means of escape
- Never attempt to re-enter the building until told it is safe to do so by Service Manager Hitendrakumar Sharma (or deputy), by a nominated fire warden or by a fire brigade officer.

Service Manager Hitendrakumar Sharma (or nominated fire safety warden) is responsible for ensuring that:

- The fire brigade has been called to any fire by dialling 999 and asking for fire service
- The fire brigade is met on arrival
- the staff nominal roll and visitor book is removed from the building and used to account for staff and visitors by roll call
- Any person not accounted for is immediately reported to the fire brigade upon arrival.

The appointed fire safety wardens are responsible for:

- Supervising evacuation assembly points
- Carrying out roll calls
- Liaising with the fire brigade on arrival.

It is Bluestar Care & Support- Bluestar Resourcing policy that an appointed fire warden should be on duty at all times.

Fire Risk Assessment Protocol

Section 156 of the Building Safety Act 2022 (BSA) has made a number of amendments to the FSO to improve fire safety in all regulated buildings. These improvements form Phase 3 of the Home Office’s fire safety reform programme, building on Phase 1 (The Fire Safety Act 2021) and Phase 2 (The Fire Safety Regulations 2023)

All Responsible Persons must:

- Record their completed fire risk assessment in full (where previously only specific information was required to be recorded)
- Record the identity of the individual (their name), and/or if applicable, their organisation (name) engaged by them to undertake/review any or all of the fire risk assessment
- Ensure that any person or company appointed to carry out a fire risk assessment is competent to do so in terms of having sufficient training and experience or knowledge
- Record their fire safety arrangements (demonstrate how fire safety is managed in our premises)
- Record (and as is necessary update) their contact information, including a UK-based address and share this with other Responsible Persons
- Take reasonably practicable steps to ascertain the existence of other Responsible Persons, who share or have duties in respect of the same premises and then identify themselves to those persons
- When leaving their post, the Responsible Person must share all relevant fire safety information with the incoming Responsible Person

Any new Responsible Person must be provided with any relevant fire safety information including:

- The fire risk assessment and review records (including any fire safety information provided by other Responsible Persons)
- The identity of any person who assisted with the fire risk assessment/review
- The name and UK address of any Responsible Person or any person acting on behalf of the Responsible Person who will accept notices or other documentation
- The identity of the Accountable Person, where known (if a higher-risk residential building)
- Any information given under Regulation 38 of the Building Regulations 2010 (such as the information provided when a building is built or extended)

It is vital that the fire risk assessment and any fire safety measures taken as a result align with, and complement any fire risk assessment(s) and fire safety measures for the rest of the building to provide a whole-building approach to fire safety.

The Responsible Person must ensure that the Fire Risk Assessment is written down and in a readily accessible format.

The Responsible Persons must provide a continual record of fire safety information throughout the building's lifetime.

The care needs assessor is responsible for carrying out fire risk assessments.

Individual home fire safety risk assessments are completed on any service user who is a smoker.

An initial home fire safety risk assessment is carried out immediately before the beginning of the service and is reviewed at the following times:

- Following a change in the health, mobility, medication, or general behaviour of the service user
- Following a change to the physical smoking arrangements at the home
- On an ongoing basis: every six months.

If the assessment identifies a danger, this is discussed with the service user and or their family along with the need for a referral to the local Fire and Rescue Service [West Sussex Fire and Rescue Service] for a home fire safety visit to their home.

Home fire safety assessment is kept in the Care and Support plan.

Organisation Premises Daily Checks

- That all fire doors are closed
- That all fire exits and stairways are free of clutter
- That all unnecessary electrical equipment and heaters are turned off
- That storerooms or rubbish areas do not have smouldering fires
- The areas where contractors have been working are free of fire hazards.

Weekly Checks

- That alarm systems function and can be heard in all parts of the building
- That all firefighting equipment is in good repair, are in place and in date
- Stocks of flammable materials or gases are kept to an absolute minimum and are stored safely away

- That all goods and boxes are safely stored away to minimize clutter, reduce the fuel available to fire and enable people to exit the building safely in the event of an emergency
- That all Fire Instruction and No Smoking notices are in place and have not been obscured
- That individual rooms do not contain obvious fire hazards such as overfull waste baskets or portable heaters placed close to curtains
- That all electrical equipment is free of obvious defects such as worn cables and exposed leads
- That Bluestar Care & Support- Bluestar Resourcing security arrangements are all in place discouraging arson.

Six Monthly Checks

A responsible person should undertake an inspection at least every 6 months as stated in Regulation 10 of The Fire Safety (England) Regulations 2022 and consider:

• If there have been any alterations or damage to the fire door
• If there are any gaps around the fire door frame and the seals and hinges are fitted correctly
• That the fire door closer shuts the door
• That the fire door closes correctly around the whole frame
• That there is no visible damage (either deliberate or from wear and tear) to the fire door or fire door closer.

Annual Checks

The Fire alarm systems, smoke detectors, emergency lighting, sprinkler systems and firefighting equipment are serviced on an annual basis by [HITENDRAKUMAR SHARMA AND 01293 300009]

Administrative Guidelines

Full records of fire precautions should be kept in the Fire Log. This information should be entered by [HITENDRAKUMAR SHARMA, REGISTERED MANAGER] or by one of the nominated fire wardens (Fire wardens are responsible for supporting the fire safety lead. Nominated fire warden posts will be reviewed every year.) and should include:

- For fire drills: the times and dates of drills, and the time between sounding the alarm and the last person leaving the building
- For fire alarm tests: the times and dates of tests
- For firefighting equipment, alarms and fittings such as emergency lighting: the times and dates of inspections, of replacements and of servicing
- For training: times and dates of training events, who attended and what was covered
- The office administrator is responsible for ensuring that the staff nominal rolls are kept up to date.

Personnel

- The nominated fire lead for Bluestar Care & Support- Bluestar Resourcing is [HITENDRAKUMAR SHARMA, REGISTERED MANAGER] who is responsible for ensuring that the correct fire procedures and arrangements are in place
- The Nominated fire warden(s) for Bluestar Care & Support- Bluestar Resourcing is Office Administrator
- Fire wardens are responsible for supporting [HITENDRAKUMAR SHARMA, REGISTERED MANAGER]
- Nominated fire warden posts will be reviewed every year

The Bluestar Care & Support- Bluestar Resourcing fire advisor is [HITENDRAKUMAR SHARMA, REGISTERED MANAGER]

All new staff are encouraged to read the policy on fire safety as part of their induction process. All members of staff should be aware of the procedures in case of a fire at Bluestar Care & Support- Bluestar Resourcing premises.

They should also all be aware of how they must respond in the event of an emergency.

All new and existing staff should know:

- Who is responsible for ensuring the correct fire procedure is carried out
- Who are the fire wardens
- The location and usage of all fire extinguishers and where special extinguishers (e.g. those suitable for use on electrical equipment) are located
- The location of break-glass fire alarm points
- The emergency fire evacuation procedures
- How to use the internal telephone systems to call the fire brigade.

In-house training sessions for existing staff should be arranged so that all relevant staff can attend a session every year.

General fire safety training will include instruction on fire prevention, what to do in the event of a fire and fire fighting. Records of staff attendance at fire training are kept in the fire log. Staff who do not attend will be identified and booked on the next session. Additional training is available for fire safety wardens.

During a fire evacuation, a safe area from the fire i.e. behind a fire door will offer protection for a minimum of 30 minutes. If 30 minutes is insufficient assisted evacuation by staff should be undertaken to move behind another fire door offering an additional 30 minutes of protection.

Training Statement

All staff, during induction, are made aware of the organisation's policies and procedures, all of which are used for training updates. All policies and procedures are reviewed and amended where necessary and staff are made aware of any changes. Observations are undertaken to check skills and competencies. Various methods of training are used including one to one, online, workbook, group meetings, individual supervision and external courses are sourced as required.

Related Policies

- Accidents, Incidents And Emergencies Reporting (RIDDOR) (Domiciliary)
- Assessment Of Need And Eligibility (Domiciliary)
- Care And Support Planning (Domiciliary)

Related Guidance

- Gov.UK Fire Safety in the Home
- Age UK: Fire Prevention Advice Gas and Electric Safety
- GOV.UK: Fire Safety Regulations 2023
- GOV.UK: Fire Safety (England) Regulations 2022

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